Ghislain Afavi

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IMF EXPERIENCE

Strategy, Policy, and Review Department (SPR), Macro Policy Division

Economist (Economist Program through September 2025) **March 2024–present**

Review policy notes and draft staff reports for a portfolio of countries. including G20 economies, with a focus on macroeconomic, external-sector, and Fund policy issues.

Lead the update of the IMF Staff Guidance Note on external sector issues.

Contribute to SPR workstream related to the review process and to the framework for addressing delays in Article IV consultations.

SPR Economist for Moldova **July 2024–July 2026**

Contributed to ECF/EFF/RSF reviews and Article IV surveillance, including missions and preparation of staff reports.

Led debt sustainability analysis, external-sector, balance-of-payments, and external sector assessment.

African Department, Madagascar Country Team

Economist Program **September 2022–March 2024**

Contributed to ECF reviews and Article IV consultation reports.

Leading work related to growth and inflation projections and updates .

Leading the debt sustanaibility analysis.

Produced analytical work on growth accounting, climate change, and informality.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Montreal, Canada	2022
M.Sc. in Statistics-Economics. African School of Economics, Benin	2016
B.Sc. in Statistics-Econometrics, University of Abomey-Calavi, Benin	2012

RESEARCH INTEREST

Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics, International Finance/Macro, Inequality

Policy publications

Social Spending Targets in IMF-Supported Programs in Sub-Saharan Africa, Departmental Paper, 2025.

Informality and Growth in Madagascar, IMF Selected Issues Paper, 2023.

Working Papers

Sudden Stops and Asset Prices: The Role of Financial Market Participation

Monetary Policy, Sticky Wages, and Household Heterogeneity

Working in progress

Monetary Policy, Financial Stability, and Inequality

The political economy of tax reforms

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Research assistant for Prof Baris Kaymak and Immo Schott	Summer 2018
Research assistant for Juste Somé, Ph.D.	2016
Statistician civil servant, Statistics-Planification Office, Ministry of Health, Benin	2014-2016
High school teacher in mathematics, Calavi, Benin	2012-2014
Statistician Intern, National Institute of Statistics of Benin	Summer 2012

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Lecturer, University of Montreal

Data analysis for economists (Undergraduate): Fall 2019, Winter 2020, Fall 2020.

Introduction to macroeconomics (Undergraduate): Winter 2021

Teaching assistant, University of Montreal

Macroeconomics (Ph.D.): Fall 2019, Fall 2020, Winter 2021.

Advanced Macroeconomics (Ph.D.): Winter 2020, Winter 2021, Winter 2022.

Macroeconomics (Msc): Fall 2020, Fall 2021.

Econometrics I (Undergraduate): Winter 2022.

Quantitative methods for economists (Undergraduate): Winter 2020.

Principle of economics (Undergraduate): Summer 2018, Fall 2018, Winter 2019.

Introduction to microeconomics (Undergraduate): Fall 2017.

Teaching assistant, African School of Economics

Macroeconomics (Msc): Winter 2016.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2021: Royal Economic Society Symposium of Junior Researchers,
60th Annual Congress of the Société canadienne de science économique

2019: Fifteenth CIREQ Ph.D. Student Conference at McGill University,
Economics Graduate Student Conference at Washington University in St Louis

FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS AND AWARDS

Ph.D. Fellowship, Department of Economics, University of Montreal	2016-2021
Ph.D. Fellowship, CIREQ, University of Montreal	2016-2021
World Bank Scholarship	2014-2016
Beninese Government Scholarship	2009-2012
Top-ranked student in Statistics-Econometrics (Undergraduate), Benin	2011

SKILLS

Software: Matlab, Stata, Fortran, Python, Latex

Household survey data: SCF (USA), PSID (USA), ENIGH (MEXICO)

Languages

French (Native), English (Advanced)